

Your Graduates Are Entering a Labor Market Your Curriculum *Wasn't Designed For.*

A comprehensive implementation mandate for modernizing university curriculum, pedagogy, faculty development, and governance for the AI-era labor market. This document is built for action — not awareness.

Research base: ITDF 2025-2026 · WEF Future of Jobs Report 2025 · McKinsey · PwC · EDUCAUSE · M

The mandate is institutional. Individual faculty effort is not a strategy. This toolkit shows you how to build systems that outlast any single motivated professor.

GOVERNANCE GUARDRAILS — READ BEFORE IMPLEMENTING ANYTHING

Faculty Authority

Final curriculum authority remains with the Faculty Senate. The AI Strategy Lead coordinates and recommends. Faculty vote approves.

GenEd as Proposal

The "AI & Society" GenEd course is a proposal for curriculum committees to approve — not a predetermined outcome. If rejected, integration proceeds through departmental pathways.

Course Elimination

Courses require a faculty vote to dissolve. AI audits identify and flag — they do not eliminate.

No Faculty Replacement

AI is a subject of study, a research tool, and a professional support system. Faculty remain responsible for instruction, mentorship, and academic judgment.

SECTION 01 · THE CASE

The Data Your Board of Trustees Should Have Seen Already

Higher education institutions have an accreditation lag, a tenure incentive problem, and a curriculum review cycle that runs on a 5-year clock in a labor market that now changes meaningfully every 18 months. These are structural vulnerabilities, not individual failures. The data below describes what your graduates are walking into.

82%

of global technology experts say AI will play a significantly larger role in shaping daily life and key societal systems in **10 years or less**

ITDF Human Resilience Report · 2026 · n=386

77%

of employers plan to upskill their workforce for AI collaboration by 2030. They will train your graduates if you don't — but they will also prefer graduates who arrive ready.

WEF Future of Jobs Report • 2025

20%

Software developers aged 22–25 saw an **almost 20% employment decline** in 2025. Entry-level professional roles — your graduates' first jobs — are being hit first.

DesignRush AI Displacement Statistics • 2026

56%

Workers with verified AI skills earn **56% more** — up from 25% in 2023. This premium reflects current scarcity. Early-moving institutions produce graduates who capture it before it normalizes into the baseline.

PwC Global AI Jobs Barometer • 2025 (up from 25% in 2023)

PwC Global AI Jobs Barometer • 2025

61%

of global technology experts say the magnitude of change in human cognitive capacities from AI adoption will be **deep and meaningful or fundamentally revolutionary** by 2035

ITDF Being Human in 2035 • 2025 • n=301

9/12

Of 12 core human capacities surveyed, **nine are expected to trend negatively** under passive AI adoption. The three that trend positive are what employers now pay a premium for.

ITDF Being Human in 2035 • 2025

"AI is quickly becoming the invisible operating system of society, shaping how opportunity is distributed, services are delivered, risks are managed and human rights are experienced. The institutions that are not preparing people for this reality are not being neutral. They are falling behind."

SYNTHESIZED FROM ITDF HUMAN RESILIENCE INFRASTRUCTURE REPORT, 2026

The Higher Education Specific Problem

Universities face a version of this problem that is structurally harder than K-12. Tenure incentivizes research output, not pedagogical innovation. Department autonomy makes cross-institutional curriculum change difficult. Accreditation cycles lag

the market. And the revenue model — tied to enrollment and endowment performance — can make urgency feel abstract until a competitor starts advertising AI-ready graduates and your enrollment numbers respond.

None of this is insurmountable. But none of it will be overcome by a provost-level memo or a task force report. It requires named ownership, structural authority, sustained resources, and public accountability. That is what this document provides.

⚠ CAUTIONARY CASE: THE BENNETT SCHOOL, HOUSTON, APRIL 2026

In April 2026, ABC13 reported on the Bennett School — a Houston voucher school where students spend two hours per day on AI-powered laptops with no certified teachers, just "guides," and the rest of the day in athletic training. The video showed a room of kids on screens, no teacher present, no instruction happening. The Houston Federation of Teachers president called it "appalling." Parents online responded accordingly. The Bennett model may be an outlier, but it set the interpretive frame for every AI-in-education story that followed — including HISD's "Future 2" initiative, a different program with teachers still in the room, which launched into a public already primed for suspicion.

This is not a critique of AI in education. It is an argument for building the standard before launching the program. When no governance framework exists to distinguish responsible AI integration from chatbot babysitting, skepticism fills the gap and one school's failure contaminates every program that follows. **This toolkit is the document that should exist before any university launches an AI strategy — so that the institution making the announcement is not the institution explaining what went wrong.**

⚠ WHAT WE DON'T KNOW — HONEST ACKNOWLEDGMENT

The specific AI tools dominant in 2030 are not knowable today. Which jobs will still exist in their current form by 2035 is genuinely uncertain — expert consensus on magnitude is high, expert consensus on specifics is low. What the research does confirm is that the skills which make graduates resilient are knowable: critical thinking, AI fluency, ethical reasoning, creativity, adaptability, and the metacognitive capacity to manage their own learning in a changing field. Build for those. The specific tool landscape will take care of itself if the foundational competencies are there.

On the hype cycle: If AI disruption proves slower or differently shaped than current projections, the curriculum built from this toolkit remains sound. The durable competencies — verification, ethical reasoning, adaptability, source evaluation, critical thinking — are valuable regardless of AI's specific trajectory. The 56% wage premium for AI skills exists now because the skill is still scarce. As AI literacy becomes universal, that premium normalizes into table stakes — which is exactly why moving first matters for current cohorts, and why the goal is not to build a permanent advantage but to ensure no graduate arrives at the labor market without skills that are rapidly becoming baseline expectations.

Before Anything Else: Designate Your AI Strategy Lead

Every university that has made meaningful progress on AI integration has one thing in common: a named, senior, empowered person whose job is to make it happen. Not a committee. Not a task force with a two-year timeline. One person who can convene faculty, hold departments accountable, and report to the President.

A committee diffuses accountability. When the work is hard — and it will be hard — committees wait for someone else to push. One owner with clear authority and adequate resources produces what committees cannot.

Who Is This Person?

✓ What to Look For

The profile of an effective AI Strategy Lead

☐ Respected by faculty — not just by the President

Faculty engagement is the job. This person needs credibility in the faculty senate and in department hallways, not just in the President's cabinet.

☐ Current academic appointment — preferably tenured or senior

Peer credibility in higher education is tied to rank. A tenured professor or senior faculty member carries more weight in faculty governance conversations than an administrator-only appointment.

☐ Demonstrated interest in pedagogy and student outcomes

This role is fundamentally about teaching and learning, not about technology. The best candidates are people who have already been innovating in how they teach — not just what they know about AI.

☐ Comfortable working across disciplines

This person will work with the engineering college and the school of education in the same week. They need to be fluent in multiple academic cultures and resist the pull of their home discipline.

⊘ Common Mistakes to Avoid

These assignments consistently underperform

☐ The Chief Information Officer

This is a curriculum and pedagogy job. CIOs think about infrastructure, security, and systems. Essential partners — wrong person for this role.

☐ An outside consulting firm

When the contract ends, institutional knowledge leaves. This role requires sustained faculty relationships and cultural understanding that external consultants cannot build.

☐ A faculty committee with shared leadership

Shared leadership is shared accountability — which is no accountability. Committees are useful as advisory bodies. They are not effective as execution engines.

☐ Someone without course release or equivalent time

Adding this to a full teaching load with full service obligations produces burnout, not results. Adequate time is not a favor — it is an operational requirement.

AI Strategy Lead / Chief AI Academic Officer

SENIOR FACULTY OR ADMINISTRATIVE APPOINTMENT · REPORTS TO PROVOST WITH DIRECT ACCESS TO PRESIDENT · 2-YEAR TERM, RENEWABLE (ALIGNED WITH IMPLEMENTATION CYCLE)

This role should be offered with genuine authority and genuine resources. **Minimum: 50% appointment (or equivalent course release) + budget authority for faculty PD (\$15,000-\$50,000 depending on institutional size) + direct representation in provost leadership meetings.**

WHAT THEY OWN

- Annual AI readiness audit — all academic departments
- Faculty PD program design, delivery, and tracking
- University-wide AI use policy and academic integrity framework
- Curriculum audit coordination across all colleges
- Employer advisory council for each college — convening and agenda
- Annual public AI Readiness Report to Board of Trustees
- Resource directory maintenance — updated each semester
- AI fluency graduation milestone framework and tracking
- Partnership with local K-12 districts and community colleges
- Internal grant program for faculty curriculum innovation

WHAT THEY DO NOT OWN

- Individual faculty hiring or tenure decisions
- IT infrastructure, tool selection, or procurement
- Disciplinary action for academic integrity violations
- Writing every department's AI-integrated curriculum
- Community and external relations communications
- Accreditation documentation (though they inform it)
- Student success case management
- Donor and alumni engagement strategy

♥ FACULTY GOVERNANCE ARCHITECTURE — NON-NEGOTIABLE

These four commitments must be explicit in any implementation plan. Without them, the AI Strategy Lead reads as an administrative end-run around shared governance — and faculty will mobilize against the entire agenda, including the parts they privately agree with.

CURRICULUM AUTHORITY

Final curriculum authority remains with the Faculty Senate and department governance structures. The AI Strategy Lead coordinates, facilitates, and recommends. The Faculty Senate approves. No curriculum change becomes institutional policy without a faculty vote.

GENED PROPOSAL

The "AI & Society" GenEd course is a *proposal* for faculty governance committees to review and vote on — not a predetermined requirement. If the GenEd Committee rejects it, integration proceeds through departmental pathways instead. The course does not bypass normal governance.

DEPARTMENTAL AUTONOMY

Departments have authority to design discipline-specific AI integration pathways. There is no single mandated model. Computer science integrates differently than nursing, which integrates differently than art history. Departmental proposals are approved by a faculty-majority oversight committee, not by the AI Strategy Lead alone.

COURSE ELIMINATION

Course dissolution requires a faculty vote — not an administrative audit decision. The AI Strategy Lead can flag courses for review. They cannot dissolve them. Departments whose courses are flagged present a response to the oversight committee. The default is retention

pending deliberation.

These commitments convert the document from "administration mandates, faculty complies" to "faculty governs, administration facilitates" — which is the posture that survives a faculty senate vote.



The AI Strategy Lead's First 60 Days — Exact Action Steps

Hand this list to your lead on Day 1. These are not suggestions.

☐ Week 1-2: Complete the EDUCAUSE "Teaching with AI" Microcredential Program

EDUCAUSE's structured 5-module online program (events.educause.edu/teaching-with-ai) is the higher education standard for faculty AI PD. Your AI Lead needs to complete this before they facilitate anything for others. 5–6 hours. Includes sample syllabus language for AI policies.

☐ Week 1-2: Survey all academic department chairs — one standardized survey

Questions: Does your department's curriculum include any AI integration? Have your faculty received any AI-related PD in the last 12 months? Does your department have an active industry advisory council? What is your greatest challenge in addressing AI in your curriculum? This is the institutional baseline. Nothing can be measured without it.

☐ Week 3: Complete MIT OpenCourseWare AI Foundations overview and identify faculty-facing resources

MIT's free AI course resources (ocw.mit.edu, aiopeneducation.pubpub.org) provide the academic depth your AI Lead needs to speak credibly in faculty conversations across disciplines. Not a substitute for EDUCAUSE, but essential for cross-disciplinary credibility.

☐ Week 3-4: Meet individually with each college Dean — listen-first agenda

Not to deliver the agenda. To understand what each Dean believes is already happening, what they're afraid of, and where they see the biggest gaps. This intelligence shapes everything that follows and these relationships determine whether the AI Strategy Lead can actually move the institution.

☐ Week 5-6: Convene a cross-college Faculty Champions cohort — 1 volunteer per department

Identify and convene faculty members in each department who are already interested in AI integration. These are not mandatory appointees — they are volunteers. This cohort will be the pilot group for PD, the source of peer learning models, and the internal advocates when skeptical colleagues push back.

☐ Week 7-8: Deliver AI audit summary to Provost with specific gaps identified and Year 1 action plan

Not a report on what the university could do. A specific document: here is what is happening now, here is what is missing, here are the 5 highest-priority actions for Year 1, here is the resource requirement, here is the timeline. This document becomes the accountability structure for the next 12 months.

What to Add, What to Reform, What to Dissolve

These are not aspirational suggestions. They are minimum standards for an institution that is serious about preparing graduates for the labor market its graduates are about to enter. The caveat: state systems, accreditation requirements, and shared governance processes vary. Some of these require formal curriculum committee processes. That is expected and worth doing.

△ CURRICULUM CAVEAT

These recommendations reflect current research and expert consensus. Specific tool choices (which AI platforms to teach) should not be hard-coded into curriculum — teach principles and practice with current tools, knowing the tools will change. What should be hard-coded: the competency outcomes. Graduates who can critically evaluate AI outputs, apply AI tools to professional tasks, and reason about AI's ethical implications will be competent regardless of which specific tools exist in 5 years.

Courses and Requirements to ADD

ADD

"AI & Society" — General Education Requirement for All Undergraduates

3 credits. Required. Not an elective. Not a STEM-only offering.

This is the single most important curriculum decision your institution can make. A required, 3-credit course taken by every undergraduate — regardless of major — that covers how AI systems work, how they affect labor markets and human capacities, how they are governed, what ethical obligations users and developers have, and how AI applies to professional practice across industries.

This course should be taught collaboratively — a team-taught model with instructors from computer science, philosophy, social science, and a professional school works well — and reviewed annually. The syllabus should be public.

How AI systems learn from data — conceptual, not coding-required

Every graduate should be able to explain to a non-technical audience: AI learns patterns from data, which means it reflects the biases and gaps in that data. This one concept explains most AI failures students will encounter professionally.

AI and the labor market — honest, data-driven analysis of what is changing

Use WEF Future of Jobs data, BLS projections, and McKinsey research. Students deserve honest information about the career environment they are preparing for, including which roles are at risk and which are growing.

Hands-on use of AI tools across professional contexts

Students should leave having used AI tools in at least 3 different professional scenarios relevant to their intended career. Not just general chatbot use — domain-specific application with critical evaluation.

Ethics, governance, and accountability of AI systems

Algorithmic bias, data privacy, AI in criminal justice, surveillance, consent — these are not abstract topics. They are the policy landscape graduates will navigate in every professional role. They need a framework for reasoning about them, not just awareness that they exist.

How to evaluate AI claims — fact-checking, source verification, uncertainty recognition

AI hallucinates. AI is confidently wrong. AI can be manipulated via prompt injection. Graduates who know this and have practiced verification protocols are more valuable than those who don't.

 **Resource:** MIT's AI + Open Education Initiative (aiopeneducation.pubpub.org) has published rapid-response papers from stakeholders across disciplines on integrating generative AI into open education — free, high-quality academic resource for course development.



"AI in [Your Field]" — Required Component in Every Major

Every department. Every major. AI's role in that field, specifically.

Each academic department must integrate a required AI-in-my-field component into its major. This is not the "AI & Society" GenEd — it is discipline-specific, professionally oriented, and tied to current employer expectations in that field. It can be a standalone course, an expanded existing methods course, or a module woven into the senior capstone. The format is less important than the substance.

The AI Strategy Lead coordinates department-by-department audits to determine what exists, what needs to be built, and what the timeline is. Every department should have a plan within 12 months and implementation within 24 months.



AI Micro-Credential Program — Stackable, Available to All Students

Built from existing free platforms. Employer-recognized. Semester-length.

A portfolio of short, employer-recognized AI credentials that any enrolled student can earn alongside their major. Partner with EDUCAUSE, Google Career Certificates, AWS Educate, or OpenAI Academy (free training via the National Applied AI Consortium) to minimize development cost. These credentials appear on the transcript and are increasingly recognized by employers as a signal of practical readiness.

Examples: "Data Analysis with AI," "AI-Augmented Research Methods," "AI in Professional Communication," "Responsible AI Deployment in Business." Each completable in one semester, stackable toward a broader certificate.

Courses to Dissolve or Fundamentally Reform

DISSOLVE

REFORM



Basic Computer Skills / Introduction to Office Software — Dissolve

DISSOLVE

Use the credit hours for something that reflects 2026.

Courses that teach students to use Microsoft Word, PowerPoint, or Excel at a basic operational level are not preparing college graduates for anything. Students who arrive at university not knowing how to use these tools need direct intervention, not a semester-long course. The credit hours consumed by basic software instruction should be redirected to AI fluency content. Reform these courses entirely into "AI-Augmented Professional Productivity" — building professional workflow skills with current tools at a professional level.

Traditional Research Methods Courses — Reform to Include AI Dimension

REFORM

Research methodology has changed. These courses must reflect that.

Every research methods course in every discipline — qualitative, quantitative, mixed methods, lab-based — should be updated to include: how AI tools are used in research in that field, what the ethical obligations of AI-assisted research are, how to cite AI assistance, and how to critically evaluate AI-generated literature summaries. This is not a new course — it is an essential update to every existing one. The AI Strategy Lead should provide a cross-disciplinary research methods update guide that departments adapt for their context.

Career Services 1-Credit "Career Development" Courses — Full Rebuild

REFORM

If it was built before 2022 and hasn't been revised, it is misleading students.

Any career development course using pre-2022 labor market frameworks, outdated career pathway descriptions, or traditional job search strategies without AI context is actively misinforming students. These courses should be rebuilt around: AI's impact on specific career paths, how to leverage AI in the job search, how to position human skills in an AI-augmented marketplace, and how to evaluate AI's risk to your intended career and build resilience.

What to Add to Existing Courses — By Discipline

Not everything requires a new course. Most of the integration needed is woven into existing ones. The following additions are specific enough to be assigned to department chairs with a 2-semester implementation deadline.

Business & Economics

- Unit: AI in financial analysis, forecasting, and risk modeling — specific tools and limitations
- Case studies: businesses that deployed AI successfully vs. those that created liability
- AI-augmented marketing, operations, and supply chain analysis — hands-on
- Ethics: AI bias in hiring algorithms, lending decisions, customer segmentation
- Required capstone component: AI audit of a real business process

Health Sciences & Nursing

- AI in clinical decision support — what it does, what it doesn't, and who is liable when it's wrong
- AI in medical imaging, diagnostics, and drug discovery — current state, not hype
- Electronic health record AI — how data is used, privacy implications, consent
- Ethics: algorithmic bias in healthcare (documented cases, real outcomes)
- Simulation lab: using AI clinical tools with explicit human oversight protocols

Education Programs

- Required: AI in K-12 and higher education — how to integrate responsibly as a future educator
- How to design AI-resistant assessments that measure actual learning
- Science of learning applied to AI-augmented classrooms
- Equity implications of AI in education — access gaps, algorithmic grading, surveillance
- AI tools for lesson planning and differentiation — hands-on with critical evaluation

Journalism & Communication

- AI in newsrooms — what it currently does, deepfakes and synthetic media detection
- Ethical standards for AI-assisted reporting — emerging professional guidelines
- AI content generation tools — hands-on with disclosure standards
- Algorithms and news distribution — why this shapes what people see and believe
- Investigative use of AI — data journalism, document analysis, pattern detection

Law & Pre-Law

- AI in legal research, contract review, and discovery — current tools and limitations
- Liability for AI errors — who is responsible when automated systems cause harm?
- AI in criminal justice — predictive policing, algorithmic sentencing, documented bias
- Emerging AI regulation — EU AI Act, US executive orders, state law developments
- Evidence standards for AI-generated content in legal proceedings

STEM Programs

- AI tools in research — literature synthesis, data analysis, hypothesis generation with critical evaluation
- Reproducibility and AI — how AI-generated results must be documented and validated
- Data science and ML fundamentals — appropriate for all STEM majors, not just CS
- Ethics in AI/algorithm development — the engineer's responsibility for downstream harm
- AI and the scientific method — how AI changes experimental design

Humanities & Social Sciences

- AI and culture — how generative AI is changing creative production, authorship, authenticity
- Algorithmic sociology — how AI shapes social behavior, political opinion, economic outcomes
- Digital humanities tools — AI in archival research, text analysis, historical pattern detection
- AI and power — who builds AI, who it serves, who is harmed, and who decides
- Research methods update: AI-assisted qualitative and quantitative analysis — ethical use

Fine Arts & Design

- Generative AI in creative practice — honest exploration of what it does and cannot do
- Copyright and AI training data — whose art was used and what the legal landscape looks like
- AI as creative collaborator vs. AI as replacement — market reality, not just philosophy
- Portfolio differentiation in an AI-abundant creative market — what makes human work valuable
- Disclosure standards in AI-assisted creative work — emerging professional norms

Why Pedagogy Must Change — Not Just Content

Adding AI content to a course is necessary but insufficient. The way courses are taught — assessed, structured, and scaffolded — must also change. Cognitive science research provides clear guidance on how humans build durable knowledge and transferable skills. These principles should be woven into AI-integrated course design from the start.

PRINCIPLE 01

Spaced Practice

Learning distributed over time produces dramatically stronger retention than intensive single-session coverage.

APPLY IN HIGHER ED:

Don't treat AI as a one-course topic. Spiral AI themes across a student's four years — introductory awareness in Year 1, discipline-specific application in Year 2–3, professional integration in Year 4. Return to core concepts with increasing sophistication.

PRINCIPLE 02

Retrieval Practice

The act of recalling information strengthens it far more than re-reading. Low-stakes, frequent testing is one of the highest-leverage pedagogical interventions available.

APPLY IN HIGHER ED:

Regular, brief retrieval exercises on AI concepts across all courses — "Before you use any AI tool today, write two sentences: what is one documented limitation of large language models, and why does it matter for what you're about to do?"

PRINCIPLE 03

Desirable Difficulties

Tasks that require real cognitive effort produce more durable learning. Removing difficulty via AI assistance can eliminate the exact struggle that builds professional competency.

APPLY IN HIGHER ED:

Require students to attempt substantive work independently before AI access. Professional programs especially: medical students who outsource clinical reasoning to AI, law students who outsource argument construction, are not building the expertise they will need. Protect the struggle explicitly.

PRINCIPLE 04

Interleaving

Mixing different skills or problem types during practice — rather than blocking all practice on one type — produces better long-term transfer to

novel situations.

APPLY IN HIGHER ED:

Cross-disciplinary AI integration is not just efficient — it is pedagogically superior. A business student who practices critical AI evaluation in economics class, communications class, and ethics class will apply that skill in a job interview far more reliably than one who only practiced it in "AI Literacy."

PRINCIPLE 05

Metacognition

Students who actively monitor and reflect on their own learning consistently outperform those who don't. This capacity is especially critical when AI tools can obscure what a student actually understands.

APPLY IN HIGHER ED:

Require AI contribution statements on any AI-assisted work. More importantly, build post-AI reflection into assignments: "What did I understand well enough to evaluate the AI's output? What would I have missed if I hadn't checked its work? What did the AI miss that I caught?"

PRINCIPLE 06

Transfer of Learning

Skills learned in one context do not automatically transfer to new ones. Transfer requires deliberate practice across multiple contexts and explicit instruction on when and how to apply skills.

APPLY IN HIGHER ED:

Cross-disciplinary AI integration serves two purposes: curriculum coverage and transfer. Explicitly teach faculty to tell students: "The critical evaluation skills you're applying here are the same skills you'll use when reviewing an AI-generated legal brief, a diagnostic suggestion, or a financial model."

PRINCIPLE 07

Cognitive Load Management

Working memory is limited. Overwhelming learners — or faculty — with too much novelty at once produces shallow processing. Sequence matters.

APPLY IN HIGHER ED:

Faculty PD should be sequenced, not front-loaded. Introduce one AI tool or concept, give faculty time to practice it in their teaching context, get feedback, then introduce the next. A one-day PD marathon followed by months of nothing is the least effective model possible.

PRINCIPLE 08

Feedback Quality and Timing

Timely, specific, actionable feedback is one of the most powerful learning accelerators. Vague, delayed, or generic feedback produces minimal improvement.

APPLY IN HIGHER ED:

AI can actually help here — AI-assisted feedback on low-stakes work can free faculty time for high-stakes, high-quality human feedback on work that most requires it. This is a legitimate and pedagogically sound use of AI in instruction, not a shortcut.

"We must make the teaching of thinking itself a central goal of education and lifelong learning. If we outsource thinking to AI, we outsource our moral capacity — our ability to ask: What does this mean? Should we do this? What are the consequences here?"

The Full Professional Development Infrastructure

Faculty development in higher education fails for two predictable reasons: it is optional, and it is disconnected from the incentive structures that actually drive faculty behavior. This plan addresses both.

⚠ If AI PD is not tied to promotion, tenure, and annual review criteria, it will be optional in practice regardless of what the policy says. Work with faculty governance on the incentive structure first, then build the PD program.

Collective bargaining note: At unionized institutions, mandatory PD requirements, workload changes tied to AI curriculum development, and any changes to how AI-related work counts in promotion and tenure review may be subject to collective bargaining. Review applicable faculty contracts and consult with legal counsel before implementing mandatory PD or tying AI integration to annual review. Frame AI development as an institutional investment in faculty, not as an additional compliance obligation — and ensure compensation matches the ask. Faculty who feel implementation is being done *to* them rather than *with* them will comply minimally and resist actively.

Phase 1: Foundation Cohort — Faculty Champions

Semester 1 · Voluntary · 1 faculty member per department · The early adopter cohort

Start with willing volunteers, not mandates. Identify 1–2 faculty members per department who are already interested. This cohort goes deep in Semester 1, develops AI-integrated curriculum for their courses, documents what works, and becomes the peer learning resource for their departments in Year 2.

- ☐ **Complete EDUCAUSE "Teaching with AI" Microcredential (5-6 hours)**
events.educause.edu/teaching-with-ai — the higher education standard. Covers AI tools, course design, assignment redesign, AI policy development, and student perspectives. Includes sample syllabus language. Required for all Phase 1 participants.
- ☐ **Redesign one existing course assignment or assessment using Science of Learning principles**
Not a new course. One assignment, redesigned. Faculty document the design rationale, deliver it, collect student and peer feedback, and present findings to the Faculty Champions cohort. This is the unit of practice that drives behavior change.
- ☐ **Produce a shareable "AI Integration Guide" for their department**
One-to-two page document: what AI tools are relevant to this discipline, how they recommend integrating them, sample syllabus language for AI transparency policy, one recommended assessment redesign approach. This is the product that makes their work reusable by their colleagues.
- ☐ **Present at end-of-semester Faculty Champions Showcase**
Publicly recognized. Recorded for the institution's resource library. Celebration of innovation is a cultural signal. These presentations are the most effective PD events your institution can run — peers are more persuasive than administrators.

Phase 2: Full Faculty Rollout

Year 2 · Mandatory Foundation + Voluntary Depth Tracks

☐ All instructional faculty: Required foundation AI PD (minimum 6 hours, verified)

Not a webinar. A structured, multi-session program facilitated by the AI Strategy Lead and Phase 1 Champions. Faculty who are adjunct or part-time must be included and compensated for participation. Completion tracked and reported in the annual AI Readiness Report.

☐ Discipline-specific depth tracks for interested faculty (12+ hours, optional stipend)

Health sciences faculty have different AI integration needs than philosophy faculty. Depth tracks built around disciplinary context produce more usable outcomes than generic AI training. Phase 1 Champions lead these. Internal grant (suggested: \$1,500-\$3,000 per participant) for curriculum development output.

☐ Annual recognition: "AI Innovation in Teaching" award — named, celebrated, board-level visibility

Symbolic recognition that costs almost nothing and signals to the entire faculty community that pedagogical innovation in this area is valued by leadership. Work with Faculty Senate to establish this award category in annual teaching award cycles.

Making AI PD Count in Promotion and Tenure

Work with the Faculty Senate and Provost to establish that significant AI curriculum development work — documented, peer-reviewed, and publicly shared — can be counted toward service and teaching components of tenure and promotion dossiers. This is not asking for a major policy change. It is asking for existing pedagogy innovation credit to explicitly include AI integration work. Many institutions have done this already.

SECTION 06 · ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

A Framework for AI Honesty — Not a Blanket Ban

Blanket AI bans produce the same outcome at every institution: students use AI anyway, they don't tell anyone, and they develop no judgment about when and how to use it responsibly. The institutions with the most sophisticated AI integrity frameworks have moved to tiered, transparent policies that teach honesty as a professional competency — because honesty about AI use is exactly what professional environments require.

I

AI-Free Zone

No AI assistance of any kind. Human cognition only.

High-stakes exams, in-person demonstrations, original creative first drafts, clinical skills assessments, oral defenses

II

AI-Transparent

AI assistance permitted with full documentation. **High-stakes Tier II work must also include an independent first attempt plus an in-class check, process portfolio, or brief oral component** — disclosure alone is not sufficient verification of learning.

Research papers, project reports, data analysis assignments, revised drafts. Requires AI Contribution Statement + evidence of independent thinking (not just disclosure).

III

AI-Collaborative

AI tool use is the explicit learning objective of the assignment.

AI & Society course activities, professional tool portfolio assignments, comparative AI evaluation projects, prompt engineering exercises

Sample Syllabus Language — Tier II (AI-Transparent)

Adapted from EDUCAUSE Teaching with AI sample policy language

AI Assistance Policy — Tier II

You may use AI tools (such as Claude, ChatGPT, Copilot, or Gemini) on Tier II assignments in this course. If you do, you must submit an AI Contribution Statement alongside your work. This statement must answer: (1) Which tool(s) did you use? (2) What did you ask it to do? (3) What did you change or reject from its output? (4) What portions of the work are entirely your own? Submitting AI-assisted work without this statement is an academic integrity violation. Submitting AI-generated work as if it were entirely your own is an academic integrity violation. The goal is honest, transparent human-AI collaboration — which is exactly what professional environments expect.

The AI-Free Declaration Track — For Students with Principled Ethical Objections

A formal, accommodated alternative pathway. Available by declaration. Verified by oral defense.

The ethical concerns that lead students to decline AI tool use are grounded in documented, real harms: the significant water and energy consumption of large-scale AI inference, labor exploitation in training data annotation, copyright violations in training datasets, and demonstrable job displacement in creative and knowledge-work industries. These are not fringe positions. The students holding them are often among the more analytically rigorous members of a class. Treating their objection as a behavioral problem to be managed is intellectually indefensible and counterproductive.

There is a more important conversation to have with these students — one that most institutions are not yet having clearly: *ethical people declining to use a technology does not reduce that technology's power, adoption, or harm. It removes the most thoughtful users from the room where the tool is being deployed and evaluated.* The students who understand AI's harms most deeply are precisely the ones whose voices are needed in conversations about how AI is governed, deployed, and constrained. Principled engagement is more powerful than principled abstention.

IMPLEMENTATION

☐ Student formally declares AI-free status at the start of each semester — in writing, filed with the department

Not an honor oath requiring surveillance. A formal acknowledgment of the student's chosen track and its requirements. Filed with the AI Strategy Lead and the relevant faculty member.

☐ All major assignments include a mandatory oral defense component — this is the verification mechanism

A student who used AI to produce work and committed it to memory can pass a written integrity check. They cannot hold up under a substantive 10–15 minute conversation with a faculty member who knows the subject. The oral defense is both the verification tool and a pedagogically sound practice that strengthens learning regardless of AI use. This should be the standard, not the exception.

☐ Rubrics explicitly reward demonstrated reasoning and analytical process — not prose polish

AI-assisted writing consistently produces cleaner, more polished prose than unassisted human writing under deadline. If polish is the implicit grading criterion, AI-Free track students are structurally disadvantaged for a factor that does not reflect their understanding of the material. Reorient rubrics toward the quality of thinking, evidence of engagement with primary sources, and analytical originality.

☐ Transcript notation: "Demonstrated Unassisted Mastery" on qualifying work

No extra credit — rewarding the absence of a tool implies that using it is inherently compromised. Instead, students who complete the AI-Free track with successful oral defenses receive a formal notation on their academic record. Graduate programs and research-focused employers will notice. Some will actively value it.

☐ Students receive explicit, honest instruction on the professional implications of their choice

Not to coerce a different decision. To ensure the decision is informed. The faculty member or the AI Strategy Lead provides: here is the current wage premium attached to verified AI fluency (56% by current PwC data), here is how hiring in your intended field is currently changing, here is what this choice costs you competitively and what it does not. Students who understand the tradeoff and make the choice anyway are exercising genuine agency. That is worth respecting. Students who make it without the information are not.

Assessment Redesign: What AI-Resistant Actually Looks Like

The goal is not assessment that is impossible to complete with AI — it is assessment that cannot be meaningfully completed without demonstrating actual learning. The following types consistently achieve this.

AI-RESISTANT ASSESSMENT FORMATS

- **Oral defense:** Student must explain and defend every claim in their written work to a panel
- **Process portfolio:** Annotated revision history showing how thinking evolved over time
- **Local context projects:** Analysis tied to specific, unpredicted local events AI has no data on
- **Timed, in-room writing:** Supervised, prompt-controlled, graded on reasoning not polish
- **In-class handwritten assignments:** Particularly valuable in writing-intensive courses as baseline verification — a student's handwritten prose under time pressure is a direct window into their actual fluency and reasoning. Comparing written work with out-of-class submissions is a meaningful integrity signal. This is especially relevant in first-year writing, creative writing, and qualitative methods courses.
- **Clinical/professional demonstration:** Observed performance in simulated or real professional settings
- **AI Audit assignment:** Student analyzes AI's output on their assignment topic and critiques its quality

ASSIGNMENTS AI TRIVIALY COMPLETES

- ✗ Generic analytical essays on broad topics ("Analyze the economic impact of globalization")
- ✗ Literature review summaries without original argument
- ✗ Standard problem sets with publicly available answers
- ✗ Discussion board posts without in-person accountability
- ✗ Book or article summaries without class-specific analytical frame
- ✗ Any take-home work with no accountability for the reasoning process

Making Career Services Actually Useful in 2026



Required Actions for Career Center Leadership

These are not suggestions for the career center. They are requirements.

☐ Annual AI labor market training for all career counselors — mandatory, assessed, documented

A career counselor who last updated their labor market knowledge in 2021 is giving students career advice based on a world that no longer exists. Annual mandatory training using WEF Future of Jobs, BLS Occupational Outlook, McKinsey's State of AI, and PwC's AI Jobs Barometer. Test comprehension. Document completion. Report in the annual AI Readiness Report.

☐ Establish AI Fluency as a formal graduation milestone — on the transcript

By graduation, every student should have demonstrated: they can use AI tools relevant to their field, they can critically evaluate AI outputs, and they understand the ethical obligations of AI use in their profession. This is documented in a portfolio or competency assessment. It appears on the academic record. Employers will ask about it. Students will take it seriously once it's credentialed.

☐ Build college-specific employer advisory councils — meeting at least twice yearly with curriculum input agenda

The employers hiring your graduates should be reviewing your curriculum — not just speaking at career fairs. Advisory councils for each college (Business, Education, Health Sciences, etc.) that provide formal curriculum feedback twice yearly. Their input should visibly change what you teach within 12 months of their feedback. Otherwise they stop showing up.

☐ Create an Alumni AI Career Advisors network — formal, structured, connected to students

Your graduates who are navigating AI disruption in their industries are your most credible career advisors for current students. A named, structured alumni network — quarterly virtual panels, LinkedIn group, one-on-one mentorship matching — provides mentorship that career staff simply cannot replicate. Costs: staff time to coordinate and a Zoom account.

☐ Audit and rebuild all career counseling materials using 2025-2026 labor market data

Every career pathway guide, interest inventory, and occupational description should be reviewed against current automation risk profiles. Any material that describes administrative, customer service, data entry, or basic financial roles without addressing AI's impact should be revised. The ACIL provides the labor market intelligence; career services provides the counseling context.

Student Data Privacy & AI Vendor Compliance

No student-facing AI tool should be in use at your institution without this framework in place first. A single board member, accreditor, or parent attorney asking "what vendors, what data, what protections?" without a documented answer creates an institutional liability that overshadows everything else in this document.



Non-Negotiable Vendor & Data Requirements

Complete this before any classroom AI tool goes live

☐ FERPA-compliant data processing agreements for every AI tool that handles student work

When students submit assignments through AI platforms, those are education records under FERPA. Written DPAs are required — not assumed. "We use it informally" is not a legal defense.

☐ Prohibited data types defined, documented, and communicated to all faculty

IEP information, accommodation plans, health records, behavioral records, disability documentation, and personally identifiable student information may NEVER be uploaded to an unapproved AI tool. State this explicitly. Faculty need clarity, not inference.

☐ Vendor contracts prohibit training AI models on student work

Many free AI tools improve their systems using user-submitted content. Student essays, code, and research are not training data for a private company. Vendor contracts must explicitly prohibit this use. If a vendor will not sign that clause, the institution should not adopt the tool for classroom use.

☐ AI-approved tools list maintained by the AI Strategy Lead and published to faculty

Faculty should not be independently selecting tools for course use without vetting. An approved list provides the framework faculty need and the protection the institution needs. Updated annually.

☐ Incident response protocol for accidental uploads of protected information

A faculty member will upload a document containing accommodation information or a student's diagnosis. The protocol should exist before it happens: who is notified, what is asked of the vendor, how the student and parents are informed, what is documented.

☐ Annual vendor compliance audit

Vendor data practices change. What was acceptable in 2025 may not be acceptable in 2027. An annual review of each approved tool's current data-use practices, terms of service, and privacy policies is required — not assumed.

POLICY STATEMENT TO ADOPT

Student learning data is not raw material for vendor product development. This institution does not authorize AI vendors to train, fine-tune, or improve commercial models using student-submitted work, assessments, or behavioral data. This position will be reflected in all vendor agreements and in the institution's published AI use policy.

Special Education, Disability & Accessibility

AI tools create real accessibility opportunities for students with disabilities — text-to-speech, adaptive formatting, multimodal content delivery, executive function scaffolding. They also create real risks. Disability accommodation documentation must never be uploaded to unapproved tools. AI-generated differentiated materials require human review before use. All AI tools approved for student use must meet WCAG 2.1 accessibility standards. Students using AI-based assistive technology should not be penalized under academic integrity policies for that use. Oral defenses — used as integrity verification for AI-Free track students — must have documented alternatives for students with speech or hearing impairments. Disability services staff must be included in any AI tool adoption process affecting their students.

Late-Career Faculty & Academic Freedom

Not every faculty member will become an AI integration champion — and forcing integration produces compliance theater, not genuine pedagogy. A tenured professor of philosophy who believes Socratic dialogue without AI tools is the correct pedagogical method for their course is not wrong. The institution's obligation is to ensure every student encounters AI literacy through their program — not to mandate that every faculty member teaches with the same tools. What is required of all faculty: understand the institution's AI use policy, do not upload protected student information to unapproved tools, and participate in baseline literacy PD. Beyond that, faculty retain pedagogical autonomy over their course design. Faculty within 5 years of retirement can contribute meaningfully through mentorship, ethics instruction, and assessment design without being compelled to rebuild their entire pedagogy.

Political Risk — Know Your Legislative Landscape

Texas SB 382 (89th Legislature, 2025) would have prohibited AI-based instruction in K-12 schools. It was referred to committee and did not advance — but it signals a political environment in which AI in education is actively contested. The best institutional protection is a documented governance framework showing that AI is treated as a subject of critical study and a supervised professional tool, that faculty governance approved all curricular changes, and that student data is protected. That is not just good policy. In the current Texas legislative climate, it is the difference between being a responsible governance model and being the cautionary example in the next session's floor debate.

📄 Lessons Learned Documentation — Required at Year 1 End and 2-Year Review

The AI Strategy Lead produces a structured Lessons Learned document at the close of Year 1 and at the 2-year review. This is a required deliverable — not a retrospective memo, not an internal email thread. A structured document: what worked and why, what failed and why, what surprised us about faculty resistance or departmental politics, what we would do differently, which resources were used and which were ignored, what employer advisory councils actually said versus what we expected. Without this document, institutional knowledge evaporates when the Lead rotates. File it in the shared repository. Hand it to the successor with a walkthrough. The 2-year cycle only compounds if each iteration is smarter than the last.

Succession Planning for the AI Strategy Lead

The institution's most common implementation failure: a strong AI Strategy Lead leaves after 18–24 months and the program stalls because everything lived in their relationships and their head. Prevent this structurally. A deputy or faculty fellow should be co-participating in the role by Month 6. All materials, vendor contacts, policy drafts, and PD resources should live in a shared institutional repository — not a personal Google Drive. Quarterly workload audits should verify the role is sustainable and flag when scope has exceeded capacity. The 2-year term structure (aligned with the implementation cycle) ensures succession is planned, not reactive. If the Lead leaves mid-cycle, the deputy has 4–6 weeks of overlap transition. If no deputy exists, the cycle pauses — not the institution's commitment to modernization, but the sprint.

SECTION 08 • EXTERNAL ACCOUNTABILITY

Accreditation: What You Need to Know Now

▲ ACCREDITATION AND AI — THE EMERGING PRESSURE

Major accreditation bodies (HLC, SACSCOC, WASC, AACSB for business, LCME for medicine, ABA for law, CAEP for education, and others) are actively developing AI-related standards and expectations. Institutions that are ahead of this conversation when standards are formally codified will face easier reviews. Those that are behind will face remediation requirements. This is not a distant risk — AACSB and CAEP have both signaled that AI competency expectations are coming into accreditation criteria. Proactive documentation of AI integration efforts is a risk management strategy.

The AI Readiness Report that this toolkit recommends producing annually is also your accreditation documentation. It should include: what AI courses and content exist, what faculty PD has been completed, what employer advisory input has been received and acted upon, what student outcomes data exists, and what the plan is for the next cycle. This is exactly the evidence accreditors need to see.

The institutions most vulnerable to accreditation challenges are those with no documented evidence of AI integration effort — not those who tried something and learned from it. Start your documentation now, even before your programs are complete.

SECTION 09 • THE FULL TIMELINE

The 2-Year Cycle: Implementation, Evaluation, and Starting Over

University curriculum cycles have traditionally operated on 5-year review timelines. That model does not fit the pace of AI development. The model below is a 2-year cycle — ambitious enough to drive real change, short enough to remain responsive to a rapidly changing environment. Each cycle builds on the last. Each review produces updated targets. The process does not end — it matures.

Every 24 months: audit what changed in AI capabilities and the labor market, evaluate what your programs actually produced, revise what didn't work, update what became outdated, and re-commit publicly.

Year 1: Foundation and Launch

Q1
AUG-OCT

Appoint, Audit, and Align Leadership

- AI Strategy Lead appointed — announced publicly, faculty governance notified
- Department chair survey completed — institutional baseline established
- AI Strategy Lead completes EDUCAUSE microcredential and MIT foundation resources
- President/Provost announces AI modernization commitment publicly — with specific targets, not vague goals
- Faculty Champions cohort identified (1-2 per department) and convened
- Draft AI Academic Integrity Framework (Three-Tier model) circulated for faculty governance review

Q2
NOV-JAN

Phase 1 PD, Policy Adoption, Curriculum Planning

- Faculty Champions cohort begins Phase 1 PD — EDUCAUSE program + discipline-specific work
- AI Academic Integrity Framework adopted — published to students and faculty
- Department chairs briefed on curriculum audit expectations and 2-year timeline
- Employer Advisory Councils convened for each college — first meeting, relationship building
- "AI & Society" GenEd course development begins — design team formed, syllabus drafting
- Career center staff complete first annual AI labor market training session

Q3
FEB-APR

Faculty Champions Showcase + Curriculum Audit Launch

- Faculty Champions Semester 1 showcase — public, recorded, widely promoted
- Phase 2 PD design complete — mandatory foundation program for all faculty Year 2
- Department-level curriculum audits begin — AI integration gap mapping
- AI Micro-Credential program identified — partner platforms confirmed (Google, AWS, EDUCAUSE)
- Employer Advisory Councils second meeting — formal curriculum feedback session
- AI fluency graduation milestone framework drafted for faculty governance review

Q4
MAY-JUL

Year 1 AI Readiness Report and Year 2 Planning

- Year 1 AI Readiness Report produced — submitted to Board of Trustees, published publicly
- Department curriculum audit results compiled — gaps identified, timelines assigned
- Faculty survey re-administered — compare to baseline for measurable change

- "AI & Society" course finalized — submitted through curriculum committee for Year 2 launch
- Student survey on AI tool access, confidence, and career preparedness
- Board of Trustees presentation: Year 1 outcomes vs. commitments, Year 2 plan

Year 2: Scale and Institutionalize

Q1
AUG-OCT

Launch AI & Society + Mandatory Faculty PD

- "AI & Society" GenEd course launches — at least 3 sections, cross-disciplinary instructors
- Mandatory Phase 2 foundation PD begins for all instructional faculty
- AI Micro-Credential program launches — promoted through career services and advising
- Obsolete courses (basic computer skills, unreformed career development) officially dissolved or reformed — board approval if needed
- AI fluency graduation milestone officially adopted — piloted with graduating seniors

Q2
NOV-JAN

Deep Curriculum Integration + Community Visibility

- At least 30% of departments have completed AI curriculum audit and begun integration
- Parent/student/community information session: "What Our University Is Doing About AI"
- Alumni AI Career Advisors network launches — first virtual panel event
- Faculty incentive structure for AI curriculum development approved by Faculty Senate
- K-12 partnership program announced — university resources available to local ISDs
- Assessment redesign workshop series begins — every college, facilitated by AI Strategy Lead

Q3
FEB-APR

First Cohort Outcomes + Depth Tracks

- First cohort of students completes AI Micro-Credentials — track by major and demographic
- Discipline-specific depth PD tracks launch for advanced faculty
- Employer Advisory Councils review curriculum changes since Year 1 — have gaps closed?
- "AI & Society" mid-year review — student feedback integrated, course refined
- Accreditation documentation audit — ensure AI integration efforts are formally documented
- Second Faculty Champions cohort (Year 2 volunteers) begins Phase 1 work

Q4
MAY-JUL

The 2-Year Review — Resetting the Cycle

- Full curriculum audit: what has changed in AI capabilities and labor market since the Year 1 baseline?
- Review "AI & Society" course — is the content still current? Update syllabus before Year 3
- Employer advisory feedback: are graduates arriving better prepared? What gaps remain?

- Year 2 AI Readiness Report — compare quantitatively to Year 1 on every measurable dimension
- Board of Trustees presentation with Year 3 targets — updated based on what the evidence shows
- AI Strategy Lead appointment renewed or successor identified with full knowledge transfer
- Set Year 3-4 cycle targets — more ambitious, informed by 2 years of outcome data

When you restart the cycle: the question is not whether you implemented the plan. It is whether your graduates are better prepared for their careers than the graduates of 24 months ago. Let that answer drive the next cycle's priorities.

RL PERSPECTIVES · AI EDUCATION MODERNIZATION TOOLKIT, 2026

SECTION 10 · THE RESOURCE DIRECTORY

Every Resource Your Institution Needs, Organized to Be Found

Maintained by the AI Strategy Lead and updated each semester. Cost indicators marked. This is the working library — not a reference list that sits in a PDF.

For Faculty and Curriculum Development

FACULTY PD · HIGHER ED · EDUCAUSE

EDUCAUSE "Teaching with AI" Microcredential

The higher education standard for faculty AI PD. 5 modules, live discussions, 5-6 hours. Covers AI tools, course design, assignment redesign, policy development, and student perspectives. Earns a digital microcredential. Faculty governance-recognized at many institutions.

events.educause.edu/teaching-with-ai

MEMBER PRICING

FREE · MIT OPEN LEARNING · CROSS-DISCIPLINARY

MIT AI + Open Education Initiative

Rapid-response papers from educators and researchers across disciplines on integrating generative AI into open education. Free. Academic depth. Useful for course development across humanities, STEM, professional programs. Speaker series ongoing.

aiopeneducation.pubpub.org

FREE

FREE · MIT OPENCOURSEWARE · FACULTY + STUDENTS

MIT OpenCourseWare AI Courses

13+ foundational AI courses from MIT available free via OCW. Includes "Driving Innovation with Generative AI" (6-week with CSAIL faculty), machine learning fundamentals, and domain-specific AI applications. Use for faculty depth learning and student supplementary resources.

ocw.mit.edu · search "artificial intelligence"

FREE

FREE · GOOGLE · FACULTY TRAINING

Google AI for Educators

Self-paced professional development for educators on generative AI. 2 hours. Free. Practical classroom applications, responsible use, and hands-on activities. Good foundation-level resource for faculty without a technical background who need a starting point.

grow.google/ai-for-educators

FREE

FREE · OPENAI · FACULTY + INSTITUTIONAL

OpenAI Academy + National Applied AI Consortium

Free training content for community college and university faculty via the National Applied AI Consortium. OpenAI Certifications piloted at Arizona State and California State University — creates student-facing credentials recognized by employers. Contact for institutional partnership.

openai.com/index/ai-education-opportunity

FREE

ANNUAL SURVEY · HIGHER ED · EDUCAUSE

EDUCAUSE AI Landscape Study

Annual survey of higher education AI adoption, strategy, faculty sentiment, and institutional AI maturity. Essential for benchmarking your institution against peers and understanding where the higher ed community is moving. Free download for EDUCAUSE members.

library.educause.edu → search "AI Landscape"

FREE

For Student-Facing Credentials and Career Preparation

STUDENT CREDENTIAL · GOOGLE · EMPLOYER-RECOGNIZED

Google Career Certificates

Industry-recognized certificates in Data Analytics, AI Essentials, Project Management, UX Design, and more. Available via Coursera. Universities can negotiate institutional pricing or access through workforce development funding. Students earn verifiable employer-recognized credentials.

grow.google/certificates

LOW COST

STUDENT CREDENTIAL · AMAZON · FREE

AWS Educate

Free cloud computing and AI skills program for students. Includes career-aligned learning paths, digital badges, and job board. Machine learning fundamentals, AI applications, and cloud computing basics. No AWS account required for students to start.

aws.amazon.com/education/awseducate

FREE

NEXTGENAI · UNIVERSITY PARTNERSHIP · OPENAI

OpenAI NextGenAI Consortium

OpenAI's institutional partnership program — universities gain access to API credits, compute funding, and collaborative AI research. MIT, Howard, Texas A&M, Oxford, and others are members. Apply for institutional partnership if your university has active AI research capacity.

openai.com/index/introducing-nextgenai

APPLY

For Labor Market Intelligence and Research

WEF Future of Jobs Report

The most comprehensive global survey of employer AI adoption, job creation and displacement projections, fastest-growing skills, and employer upskilling plans. Published annually in January. Essential for curriculum advisory councils and career services training.

weforum.org/publications/future-of-jobs

FREE

ITDF Research Reports (2025-2026)

The research base for this toolkit. "Building a Human Resilience Infrastructure for the AI Age" (2026) and "Being Human in 2035" (2025) are the most policy-relevant. Free PDF downloads. Essential for board presentations and accreditation documentation.

imaginingthedigitalfuture.org

FREE

TeachAI Policy Guidance

AI policy guidance for educational institutions of all levels. Developed by CSTA, Khan Academy, and others. Includes sample institutional policy language, implementation guides, and a community of institutions sharing practices. Useful for academic integrity framework development.

teachai.org

FREE

The President's Annual Accountability Checklist

This checklist should be completed by the AI Strategy Lead annually, reviewed by the Provost, presented to the Board of Trustees, and published in the AI Readiness Report. The act of measuring is as important as the metrics themselves.



Year-End Review Checklist — For President and Board

If you cannot answer these with specific numbers, the gap is real

☐ **AI Strategy Lead: Named, active, adequately resourced (at least 50% appointment equivalent)**

Y/N and the person's name. If N, this is the root cause of every other failure on this list.

☐ **% of departments with completed AI curriculum audit (target: 30% Y1, 80% Y2, 100% Y3)**

Named departments. Not approximations. If Engineering is at 100% and Education is at 0%, that gap is the next conversation.

☐ **"AI & Society" GenEd requirement: In development (Y1), launching (Y2), required for all majors (Y3)**

One of the highest-impact single decisions your institution can make. If this is not moving, name the barrier specifically.

☐ **% of instructional faculty who completed meaningful AI PD (target: 20% Y1, 60% Y2, 90% Y3)**

Track by college. If one college is at 80% and another is at 10%, the gap needs targeted support — not another all-faculty memo.

☐ **AI Fluency graduation milestone: Drafted (Y1), piloted (Y2), institutionalized (Y3)**

When employers ask your Career Center "do your graduates have AI fluency?" — what do you say? This milestone is the answer.

☐ **# of students who completed AI micro-credentials this year, tracked by major and demographic**

If only STEM students are earning AI credentials at a university, you have an equity problem and a liberal arts employability problem simultaneously.

☐ **Employer Advisory Councils: Active in each college, met at least twice, curriculum feedback documented and actioned**

If the council exists but has not changed anything in your curriculum, it is a ceremonial function. Ceremonial functions don't justify the time investment.

☐ **Career center staff: Completed annual AI labor market training, all counseling materials updated**

Ask a career counselor: "What is the automation risk profile for a student who wants to be a paralegal? An accountant? A journalist? A nurse?" Their answers tell you whether the training landed.

☐ **AI Readiness Report: Published publicly, reviewed by Board of Trustees, includes year-over-year comparison**

If this report does not exist, you have not created public accountability for your commitments. Peer institutions that publish theirs will use it as a competitive advantage.

☐ **Accreditation documentation: AI integration efforts formally documented and included in accreditation records**

This is also your risk management strategy. Don't wait for accreditors to ask — document proactively and continuously.

☐ **K-12 partnership: At least one active partnership with local school district — named, active, mutual benefit**

The university that positions itself as the community's resource for AI literacy builds goodwill, enrollment pipelines, and community trust simultaneously. The partnership doesn't need to be large. It needs to exist.

The students sitting in your classrooms right now will enter the labor market their degrees promised to prepare them for. That labor market has changed. Your curriculum has not changed as fast. The gap between those two realities is the responsibility this document describes. The choice to act on it — or not — belongs to you.

PRIMARY RESEARCH SOURCES

Elon University ITDF: "Building a Human Resilience Infrastructure" (2026) · "Being Human in 2035" (2025)
WEF Future of Jobs Report 2025
McKinsey State of AI 2025
PwC Global AI Jobs Barometer 2025
EDUCAUSE AI Landscape Study 2025

FACULTY DEVELOPMENT RESOURCES

EDUCAUSE Teaching with AI: edUCAUSE.edu
MIT AI + Open Education: aiopeneducation.pubpub.org
MIT OpenCourseWare: ocw.mit.edu
Google AI for Educators: grow.google/ai-for-educators

STUDENT CREDENTIALS & PARTNERSHIPS

Google Career Certificates: grow.google/certificates
AWS Educate: aws.amazon.com/education/awseducate
OpenAI NextGenAI: openai.com
TeachAI: teachai.org

ABOUT THIS TOOLKIT

This document is free to share, print, and adapt. Two companion documents available: this university mandate and a separate K-12/ISD Superintendent toolkit. Share it with every department chair and provost you know — the more institutions that move, the harder it is for any single institution to justify standing still.

Built by **Ryan Lester** · RL Perspectives, LLC — rlperspectives.com · May 2026